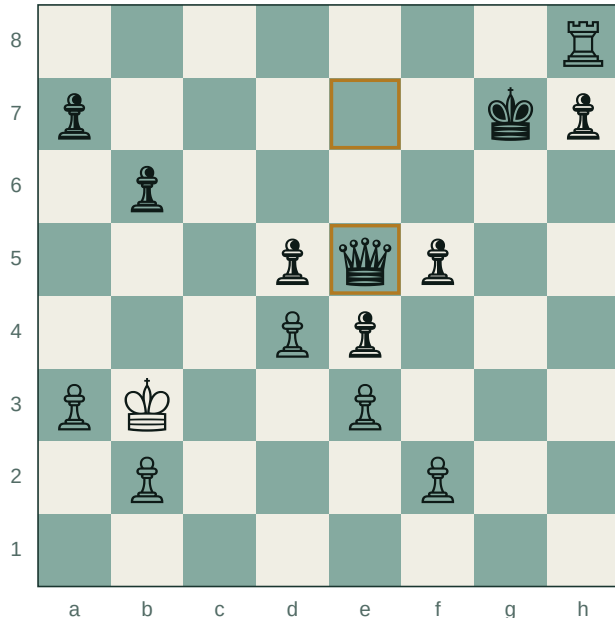


Queen-and-rook endings: White, move 28

Queen-and-rook endings

White to move



Previous move: 27...Qxe5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

28. Rxh7+ Kxh7 29. dxe5 d4 30. exd4

28.Rxh7+ Check restricts Black to 5 legal replies here. The move also takes the pawn on h7. Recorded reply: **28...Kxh7**.

29.dxe5 The pawn captures the queen on e5. Recorded reply: **29...d4**.

30.exd4 The pawn captures the pawn on d4.

At the end, nominal material is White 5 / Black 4 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +6. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +6: the balance goes from -5 to +1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Do not activate the king as casually as in a pure pawn ending. The remaining heavy pieces can still generate a mating net.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

When queens and rooks remain, mating threats coexist with endgame pawn races. Coordination and king shelter remain essential even on a sparse board.

HOW TO LOOK

Look for heavy-piece batteries, skewers, and checks that force a defender away from a promotion square or pawn.

The defending king is on g7. Geometrically undefended: queen on e5. Check for tactical protection.